

The universe

Our universe is everything there is—galaxies, stars, planets, moons, and even space and time. The universe is so incredible and vast that it is difficult to fully understand it. We on planet Earth are just one tiny speck in the universe, and it will perhaps always remain a mystery to us.

Early stars were massive and produced heavy elements that would one day form planets.

Our galaxy, the Milky Way, is one of the oldest in the universe.

500 million years old

These stars were pulled together by gravity into collections of hundreds of billions of stars to form the first galaxies, including our own Milky Way.

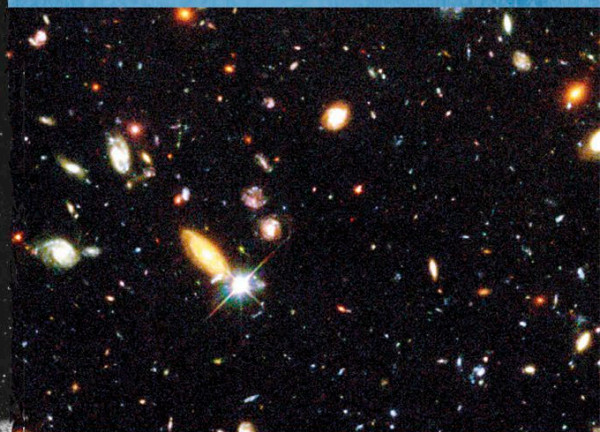
13.8 billion years old

Today, the universe is still expanding. It is a vast collection of galaxies, gas, and strange things we are still trying to understand.

Georges Lemaître In 1927, Belgian astronomer Georges Lemaître was the first person to suggest the universe started with a big bang. At the time, few astronomers believed him.



The Hubble Space Telescope This special telescope has taken hundreds of pictures of space. Inside one tiny, dark patch, astronomers found 10,000 distant galaxies, each containing hundreds of billions of stars.



What happens next? Nobody knows! What we do know is that the universe is still expanding. If this continues, it will eventually become even colder and darker.

Galaxies are pushed apart as the universe expands.

